

Ἠλίας ὁ Νεοπλατωνικός

Elias the Neoplatonist: Commentary on Aristotle and Porphyry

eul_aid: vgs

Period: Ὀψιμαρχαία Late Antique
Dialect: Κοινή φιλοσοφική Philosophical Koine
Domain: Φιλοσοφία Philosophy
Format: Πραγματεία Treatise
Affiliation: Neoplatonist

Elias was a Neoplatonic philosopher active in the 6th century CE in Alexandria. He was a student of Olympiodorus and belonged to the final generation of the Alexandrian Neoplatonic school. His career is notable as he was a Christian who taught and wrote within the traditionally pagan Neoplatonic tradition.

His surviving works are commentaries written for teaching purposes. These include a complete commentary on Porphyry's Isagoge, a standard introduction to logic, and a commentary on Aristotle's Categories. The survival of a commentary on Aristotle's Prior Analytics is less certain; it may have existed but is likely fragmentary or lost, and its full attribution remains unclear.

Elias is significant for understanding the transmission of classical philosophy at the end of antiquity. His clear, didactic commentaries preserve the standard interpretations and curriculum of the Neoplatonic school. As a Christian Neoplatonist, his work illustrates how pagan philosophical traditions were maintained and adapted within a Christian society, particularly in the Eastern Roman Empire. His writings were influential in the subsequent Byzantine philosophical tradition.

Works (3)

- Σχόλια Ἠλίου εἰς τὰς κατηγορίας Ἀριστοτέλους · Commentaries-Aristotle in Greek · 149 passages
- Σχόλια εἰς τὰ ἀναλυτικά πρότερα Ἀριστοτέλους · Commentary-Aristotle's Prior Analytics · 6 passages
- Περὶ τῆς Πορφυρίου Εἰσαγωγῆς · On Porphyry's Isagoge · 103 passages

Other Neoplatonist Authors

- Ἀμελίου Ἐπιστολή · Amelius Letters · 1 work
- Ἀμμώνιος ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · Ammonius of Alexandria Phil · 5 works
- Δαμάσκιος ὁ Δαμασκηνός · Damascius of Damascus · 7 works
- Δαβὶδ ὁ Ἀνίκητος · David the Invincible · 2 works
- Δέξιππος ὁ Νεοπλατωνικός · Dexippus the Neoplatonist · 1 work
- Εὐσέβιος ὁ Μύνδιος · Eusebius of Myndus · 1 work
- Ἱεροκλῆς ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · Hierocles of Alexandria · 1 work
- Ἰάμβλιχος ὁ Ἀνώνυμος · Iamblichus Anonymous · 1 work

- [Ίάμβλιχος ὁ Χαλκιδεύς · Iamblichus of Chalcis](#) · 6 works
- [Ίάμβλιχος ὁ Χαλκιδεύς · Iamblichus of Chalcis II](#) · 1 work
- [Ίουλιανὸς ὁ Ἀποστάτης · Julian the Apostate](#) · 20 works
- [Μαρῖνος ὁ Νεαπολίτης · Marinus of Neapolis](#) · 1 work